

Type 7 • SO

SO 7 — The Sacrifice (Social Seven Counter-Type)

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

This report is designed as a session prep tool — organized around the debrief conversation you'll have with your client, not around how the assessment engine arrived at its hypothesis. Read Section 1 for the quick read. Use Sections 2 through 5 as a companion during the debrief itself. Section 6 offers contingency guidance depending on how the conversation unfolds.

1 • YOUR READ ON THIS CLIENT

PRIMARY HYPOTHESIS**Type 7 — The Enthusiast****DOMINANT INSTINCT****Social (SO)****CONFIDENCE****MEDIUM****ALTERNATE TO HOLD LIGHTLY****Type 2 — The Giver****COUNTER-TYPE****Confirmed — SO 7 — Sacrifice (Social Seven counter-type)**

THE READ

This client comes in presenting as a deeply devoted, other-oriented giver — 'warm, generous, devoted to the people and causes I care about, tireless' — with others reflecting back 'selfless, visionary, always there.' That language is going to feel like Type 2 on first read, and the assessment data agrees that Type 2 is genuinely in play. What tips the hypothesis toward Type 7 is the Object Relations Frustration answer, the stress movement toward One (not Eight), the security movement toward Five (not Four), and the counter-type framing that makes 'Social Seven — Sacrifice' the most coherent single explanation for the full picture. The SO 7 counter-type redirects Seven's characteristic enthusiasm away from personal pleasure and entirely into cause-driven service, producing exactly this presentation. The most diagnostic piece of Stage 0 is 'inspire people toward something bigger than themselves' — that's a Social Seven formulation, not a Two formulation. Burnout as the identified shadow is also coherent with a Seven who has converted all forward motion into service and lost the thread of personal aliveness.

GOING IN

- Confidence is MEDIUM. The structural architecture (stress to One, security to Five, Object Relations Frustration) supports Type 7. The counter-type framing resolves the surface appearance. But the Hornebian Compliant answer, the Stage 3 BOTH result, and the Stage 4 Habit of Mind lean toward Two mean this is not settled — present the hypothesis as a starting point, not a conclusion.
- The client may strongly resist the standard Type 7 description (spontaneous, pleasure-seeking, variety-loving) — because the SO 7 counter-type doesn't present that way. Open with the counter-type framing explicitly, or you risk losing them before you've found common ground.
- Type 2 is the most likely point of pushback or confusion. Have the 7/2 distinguishing question ready: is the generosity energized by aliveness and meaning (Seven) or by needing to be needed (Two)? That's the question this client needs to sit with.
- The Habit of Mind anomaly is the most significant unconfirmed dimension — the client answered toward Two's attention pattern (flattery, attending to others' needs and approval) rather than Seven's (planning, reframing, forward possibility). This is worth surfacing directly in the debrief: 'When you think about where your attention goes most naturally — toward what's possible and what's next, or toward what others need and whether they're pleased with you — which lands more honestly?'

1A · COUNTER-TYPE CONSIDERATIONS

WHY THIS MATTERS

- The SO 7 Sacrifice counter-type is one of the most commonly mistyped configurations in the whole Enneagram — it consistently reads as Type 2, and this client's Stage 0 language would support that read on surface inspection alone. Without counter-type framing, you'd likely be debriefing a Two.
- The counter-type framing is also the key to unlocking the client's recognition. 'The tireless enthusiast who has turned all that energy outward in service of others' is a description that can land where 'fun-loving spontaneous Seven' would bounce off completely.
- The client named 'burnout' as their shadow — which in Seven terms signals the exhaustion of a system that has never learned to stop, refuel, or let something be painful. That's a fundamentally different diagnosis than Two's burnout, which comes from over-giving in service of securing love. Getting the framing right matters for the growth work.
- The stress movement to One (confirmed) is a useful anchor point — it's specific and structural, and it's unlikely a Two client would identify as strongly with perfectionistic criticism under stress as their primary stress pattern.

STANDARD VS. COUNTER-TYPE PRESENTATION

- Standard Seven presentation: spontaneous, variety-seeking, future-oriented, avoids pain through reframing and keeping options open, can look scattered or commitment-averse. The client shows none of this on the surface.
- SO 7 Sacrifice counter-type: redirects Seven's energy entirely outward toward group vision and collective uplift. Appears selfless, visionary, devoted, and tireless. The personal pleasure-seeking is sublimated — they

are inspired by the mission rather than by their own enjoyment. Looks almost indistinguishable from Type 2 in surface behavior.

- What they share with the standard Seven: the same underlying fear of limitation and pain, the same Object Relations Frustration pattern (the world doesn't give them enough of what they need), the same stress movement to One, the same security access to Five. The motivation is the same — the channel is different.
- The distinguishing motivation: the SO 7's giving is energized by being part of something alive and meaningful — the cause sustains them. A Two's giving is energized by being needed and loved — they need the relationship to reflect back their value. This distinction is subtle but consequential for growth work.

COACHING NOTES

- Lead with the counter-type framing before you introduce 'Seven' as a label — something like: 'There's a specific expression of Type 7 that looks almost nothing like the standard description. I want to describe it first, and then we can see if the label fits.' This prevents premature rejection.
- Use the client's own language as the entry point: 'tireless,' 'devoted to causes,' 'inspire people toward something bigger' — these are SO 7 expressions, and reflecting them back as such gives the client somewhere to stand before you introduce the type number.
- If the client says 'but I'm not spontaneous' or 'I don't avoid commitment,' meet that directly: 'You're right — the counter-type doesn't look like that. What the Seven pattern is really about is [core motivation]. Does that land differently?'

2 • DEBRIEFING CORE MOTIVATION AND WORLDVIEW

How to present the heart of the type and connect it to their own words.

THE CORE PATTERN

- Type 7's core worldview: the world is full of possibility, but limitation, pain, and deprivation are real threats — and the self-preservation strategy is to keep moving, keep options alive, and reframe any closing-down experience into an opening. In the SO 7, this plays out as: 'the cause is the opening — as long as I'm serving something meaningful, I'm not trapped.'
- The core motivation is not pleasure-seeking in the hedonic sense — it's the avoidance of inner emptiness, pain, and the sense of being cut off from what makes life feel full and alive. For this client, 'the causes I care about' and 'the people I'm devoted to' are the vehicles through which that fullness is maintained.
- The Frustration triad signature: Sevens fundamentally feel that the world doesn't give them enough of what they need — there's always more that could be experienced, contributed, made possible. This client's 'tireless' quality reads as the behavioral output of that frustrated hunger: if I keep going, I can outrun the emptiness.
- The growth edge for Sevens is learning to be present with limitation, pain, and depth without needing to transform it into something else. 'Burnout' as the named shadow suggests this client is approaching that edge — the perpetual motion is not sustainable, and something in the system is starting to register it.

WHAT THEIR RESPONSES SHOWED

- 'Devoted to the people and causes I care about' — not just caring about people, but devoted to causes. This is Seven's meaning-hunger expressed through the Social instinct's collective orientation. A Two would likely say 'the people in my life' rather than 'causes.'
- 'Tireless' — Seven's forward motion is present here. The quality that generates burnout is not the over-giving of a Two; it's the inability to stop, to rest, to let limitation be real.
- 'Inspire people toward something bigger than themselves' as greatest strength — this is the SO 7 Sacrifice formulation exactly. The Seven's aliveness is channeled into collective uplift; their enthusiasm becomes visionary leadership.
- 'Sometimes to a fault' in others' description of 'always there' — this note of shadow awareness from others is interesting. It may suggest that the client's tirelessness can tip into something others find difficult to be around, which is worth gently exploring.

COACHING NOTES

- Don't rush to the 'Type 7 avoids pain' framing early — this client has likely built a strong self-narrative around selflessness and devotion, and landing too quickly on 'your generosity is a pain-avoidance strategy' will feel reductive and wrong. Build the internal logic of Seven first, then let the client draw the connection.
- The most productive entry point is probably the burnout: 'What does it feel like when you start to hit the wall? And what do you typically do next?' This opens the forward-motion pattern without diagnosing it.
- Watch for explanation when you name the avoidance dimension — if the client starts to explain why their giving is genuinely selfless and not avoidant, that's worth gently noticing. Consider saying: 'I notice you moved into explaining just now — what's happening inside?'

Try asking: 'When you're most alive in your work — when something feels really worth giving yourself to — what is that experience like on the inside? What's the quality of it?'

3 · DEBRIEFING PATTERNS OF THINKING, FEELING, AND BEHAVING

What to expect and what to watch for as you walk through type patterns.

CENTERS OF INTELLIGENCE

Body Center		0 / 18
Heart Center		0 / 18
Head Center		0 / 18

LIKELY TO RESONATE EASILY

- Genuine optimism and the ability to see possibility where others see obstacles
- Quick thinking, versatility, and a gift for synthesizing ideas across domains

- Real warmth and enthusiasm that energizes groups and relationships

MAY TAKE MORE CAREFUL UNPACKING

- Scattered attention — too many open loops, too many half-started projects, too many possibilities
- Avoidance of pain, limitation, and commitment that would require you to stay when things get hard
- A tendency to reframe difficulty toward the positive so quickly that real feelings don't get processed

MAY BE HARDEST TO SEE

- The most likely shadow outside this client's current awareness is the pain-avoidance function of their tirelessness. They will almost certainly experience their devotion as genuine and freely chosen — and it is. What may be invisible is how the perpetual motion also keeps them from having to sit with inner emptiness, grief, or limitation. The burnout they named may be the first real encounter with that.
- A secondary shadow: the Frustration pattern — the implicit sense that the world doesn't give them enough of what they need. This client may present as grateful and devoted, but underneath there may be a chronic low-grade frustration that their causes never quite get where they need to go, that people don't rise to the vision as fully as they could. This is worth listening for.
- The Habit of Mind anomaly (attention toward others' needs and approval, leaning Two) may point toward a shadow pattern of needing to be seen as selfless and indispensable — a way of securing connection that a pure Seven framing doesn't fully capture. This is worth holding lightly as a possible complicating thread.

HOW THE CLIENT APPEARS TO MOVE — THE THREE FRAMEWORK SIGNALS

These are cross-referenced patterns that showed up consistently in their responses. Each offers a different lens on the type — worth weaving in conversationally rather than introducing as categories.

SOCIAL STYLE — COMPLIANT

- The client answered Compliant in the Hornebian framework, which is structurally anomalous for Type 7 (standard Assertive) but coherent for the SO 7 counter-type: the counter-type has bent the Seven's assertive energy into the shape of service and devotion.
- Compliant types move toward others and toward an ideal — for this client, that ideal appears to be the cause or the vision. The tirelessness and devotion are expressions of moving toward, not away from or against.
- This is also the dimension that keeps Type 2 alive as an alternative: Twos are genuinely Compliant, and this client may be presenting a true Compliant stance that the Seven hypothesis has to account for rather than explain away.

Weave in: 'When you think about what you feel most called toward — the people, the causes — does it feel more like you're pulled by something alive and meaningful to you, or more like you're responding to what others need from you?'

EMOTIONAL STYLE — POSITIVE OUTLOOK

- Positive Outlook types reframe difficulty through an optimistic or forward-oriented lens — they move away from negative experience by finding the possibility within it or minimizing its impact. For this client, 'tireless' may be the behavioral expression of this: as long as I can find the next meaningful thing, I don't have to sit with what isn't working.
- Both Type 7 and Type 2 sit in this harmonic group, so it doesn't discriminate between them — but it does help explain why 'burnout' is the named shadow rather than something more acute. The Positive Outlook style often means the cost accumulates slowly and invisibly until the system can't sustain it.
- In session, notice if the client tends to reframe challenges into opportunities quickly — this is a Positive Outlook tell that can surface naturally in debrief conversation.

Weave in: 'When something in your work or relationships goes wrong or feels painful, what do you typically do with that? How long does it stay with you before you find the way forward?'

ATTACHMENT STYLE — FRUSTRATION

- Frustration triad types (1, 4, 7) have a deep sense that the world doesn't deliver what they need — there's always a gap between what is and what could or should be. For Sevens, this shows up as a persistent hunger for more aliveness, more meaning, more possibility.
- This is the dimension that most clearly favors Type 7 over Type 2 — Twos sit in the Rejection triad, not Frustration. If this client can locate a chronic sense that things never quite get where they could go, that people don't rise to the vision as fully as they might, that's Frustration speaking.
- For an SO 7, the frustration is often expressed as a kind of visionary impatience: 'We could be doing so much more.' This is worth listening for as a thread beneath the devotion and selflessness.

Weave in: 'Is there a recurring sense — even a quiet one — that things could be more than they are? That people or situations could rise to something bigger, but often don't quite get there?'

COACHING NOTES FOR THIS SECTION

- Pace the shadow material carefully. This client has a strong self-narrative of selfless devotion, and moving too quickly to 'this is what you're avoiding' will land as an accusation rather than an insight. Build the internal logic of the type first, then invite the client to locate the shadow in their own experience.
- The Positive Outlook harmonic means this client will likely reframe challenges in real time during the debrief — notice when that happens and name it gently rather than following the reframe.
- The Frustration triad probe is likely the most generative avenue — it's less threatening than 'you avoid pain' and more likely to produce genuine recognition. Listen for moments when the client's frustration surfaces beneath the generosity.

Try asking: 'If you had to stay with something difficult — a real loss, a real limitation, something that couldn't be fixed or reframed — what happens in your body? What does that feel like?'

4 · DEBRIEFING INSTINCT AND SUBTYPE

Their particular flavor of Type 7, and why it matters.

INSTINCT RANKING

SO 7 — THE SACRIFICE (SOCIAL SEVEN COUNTER-TYPE) — HOW THE INSTINCT SHAPES THE TYPE

- The Social instinct directs this client's Seven energy entirely outward toward group, vision, and collective purpose. Where another Seven might chase personal experiences, this client channels their enthusiasm into 'inspiring people toward something bigger than themselves' — the group's aliveness becomes the vehicle for their own.
- The SO instinct also means this client is acutely attuned to what the group needs, what the mission requires, what will uplift and inspire others. This makes the Sacrifice counter-type's appearance of selflessness feel completely genuine — it is genuine. The question is what it also serves.
- The Social instinct's relationship to belonging and contribution means this client may have significant difficulty stepping back from the group, the cause, or the people who need them — rest and personal replenishment can feel like abandonment.
- 'Tireless' and 'always there' are SO instinct expressions: the client's identity is organized around showing up fully for the collective, and the burnout is the cost of never allowing the Social instinct to find its own floor.

WHY THIS SUBTYPE CAN BE EASY TO MISS

- The SO 7 Sacrifice counter-type is the hardest Seven to identify because it presents as the opposite of the type's standard description. No spontaneity, no obvious pleasure-seeking, no commitment avoidance — instead: devotion, vision, selflessness, cause-orientation.
- The typical misread is Type 2 — 'The Giver.' Both types in this configuration are other-oriented, warm, generous, and prone to burnout. The standard typing tools that don't account for counter-types will reliably land here.
- A subtler misread is Type 1 — if the cause-devotion has a strong quality of rightness or principled commitment, the Compliant Hornebian answer can amplify this. Listen for whether the client's sense of mission has a 'this is what's right' quality (One) or a 'this is what's alive and worth being part of' quality (Seven).
- The counter-type is also easy to miss in self-report because the client may not connect with 'Seven' as a self-description — they may associate Seven with superficiality or self-indulgence and actively distance from the label.

COACHING NOTES

- Introduce the counter-type framing explicitly and early: 'There's a version of Type 7 that looks almost nothing like the standard description. I want to describe it first before we talk about the label.' This prevents the label from creating a barrier to recognition.
- Use the stress and security confirmations as anchors — they're structural and less susceptible to counter-type camouflage. 'Under stress, do you find yourself becoming more critical and perfectionistic?' is a question that doesn't depend on the standard Seven presentation and can create a foothold.
- Watch for the client's relationship to the word 'Seven' — if they know the Enneagram and have a preformed image of Seven that doesn't match their self-perception, name the counter-type distinction directly and let them sit with it.

Try asking: 'When you think about what sustains you — what keeps you going through the tirelessness — is it the aliveness of the cause itself, or is it knowing that the people you're serving need you there?'

5 • DEBRIEFING WINGS, LINES, AND RESOURCES

What they have available, especially under pressure.

STRESS MOVEMENT — TOWARD TYPE 1

- Under stress, Sevens move toward Type 1: the forward-motion, possibility-oriented energy inverts into criticism, rigidity, and perfectionistic standards. For this client, this might look like suddenly becoming critical of how the work is being done, setting impossibly high bars for themselves or others, or finding fault where they previously found inspiration.
- The client confirmed this pattern (BOTH_MORE_A toward One), which is the clearest structural confirmation in Stage 4. This is worth naming in the debrief — 'Does that shift into critical and perfectionistic feel familiar under high stress?' — because it tends to produce strong recognition in Sevens even when the standard description doesn't.
- The coaching angle: stress movement to One is often a signal that the Seven has run out of road to reframe. When the optimism runs dry and criticism emerges, that's a sign that something genuinely difficult needs to be sat with rather than solved.

Try asking: 'Think of a time when you were under real pressure — burned out, overextended. What did you find yourself thinking about yourself and the people around you? Did a critical or perfectionistic quality show up?'

SECURITY MOVEMENT — TOWARD TYPE 5

- In security, Sevens access Type 5's positive qualities: the ability to be still, focused, and genuinely present without needing to keep generating. For a client whose default is tireless forward motion, this is a profound resource — the capacity to slow down and go deep without it feeling like a trap.
- The client confirmed this pattern (BOTH_MORE_A toward Five), noting both stillness and the ability to go deep. This is worth exploring as an aspirational state: when do you feel able to be still and focused? What

conditions allow that?

- The growth edge for this client is learning to access the Five movement intentionally — not just when circumstances force rest, but as a chosen practice of depth over breadth.

Try asking: 'Are there moments — maybe rare ones — when you feel genuinely still and able to go deep without needing to move on to the next thing? What's different about those moments?'

WINGS — TYPE 6 AND TYPE 8

- Type 7's wings are Type 6 (The Loyalist) and Type 8 (The Challenger). These wings flavor rather than replace the core type, and the SO 7 counter-type framing makes wing influence particularly interesting to explore.
- The Six wing brings a quality of loyalty, warmth, and attunement to others' fears and needs — it can amplify the SO 7's relational devotion and add a quality of responsibility and care for the group's safety. A Six-wing Seven may also carry more anxiety beneath the enthusiasm.
- The Eight wing brings directness, vision, and a willingness to assert and lead. For an SO 7, the Eight wing can amplify the visionary quality — 'inspire people toward something bigger' has an Eight-wing quality to it. It can also bring more decisiveness and the capacity to confront what isn't working.
- Let the client lead here — describe both briefly and invite them to notice which feels more familiar. Watch for whether the Eight wing description resonates in a way that complicates the Compliant Hornebian answer.

Try asking: 'As you hear about the Six wing — loyal, attuned to others' fears, responsible — and the Eight wing — direct, visionary, willing to confront — does one of those feel more like a familiar flavor in how you show up?'

6 • IF THE CONVERSATION GOES SIDEWAYS

What to do depending on how they receive the hypothesis.

IF THEY RESONATE STRONGLY

- When recognition lands strongly, move from 'yes, that's me' to 'and what does that cost you' — this client's named shadow (burnout) gives you a direct entry point. Strong recognition is most valuable when it opens the pattern rather than closes it.
- Invite them to locate the pattern in a specific current situation rather than in general terms — 'where do you see this most clearly in your life right now?' keeps the conversation generative rather than abstract.

Try asking: 'Now that this is landing — where do you most want to start? What's the piece of this that feels most alive or most urgent for you to work with?'

IF THEY PUSH BACK OR DISAGREE

- Do not defend the hypothesis. If the client pushes back, the most likely source is: 'I don't recognize myself in the standard Seven description' — in which case the counter-type framing is the bridge. Have the SO 7 Sacrifice description ready as an alternative entry point.
- If the pushback is 'I think I'm a Two,' honor that and move into the distinguishing question directly. The key data points that favor Seven over Two are: stress movement to One (not Eight), security movement to Five (not Four), and the Object Relations Frustration answer. Bring these as anchors, not as arguments.
- If the pushback persists, name the genuine ambiguity honestly: 'These two types are genuinely close in your data, and both have real signal. The question is which core motivation feels more true.' Let the client sit with that rather than forcing resolution.
- Watch for the Positive Outlook harmonic in the pushback itself — if the client is reframing the type descriptions to make them fit a preferred self-image, name that gently.

Most likely alternate type: Type 2 — The Giver

Key distinguishing question: *The key distinguishing question is: when you give so generously and show up so completely for others, what is the deeper driver — is it the aliveness and meaning of being part of something bigger (Seven), or is it a need to be needed and to secure your place through giving (Two)?*

IF THEY'RE CONFUSED OR NEED MORE CLARITY

- If the client is genuinely confused, find the foothold in the confirmed Stage 4 data: 'Let me ask you something specific — under real stress, do you find yourself becoming more critical and perfectionistic? And in moments of genuine ease, do you sometimes become more still and focused, able to go deep?' These questions don't depend on the standard type description and tend to produce recognition when everything else is murky.
- Treat what doesn't fit as equally useful: 'The places where this doesn't land are often the most interesting — can you say more about what feels off? What would need to be different for it to feel accurate?' This keeps the client engaged rather than defensive.
- The counter-type framing is the most important tool for confusion — if the standard Seven description is the source of the confusion, the SO 7 Sacrifice description may resolve it entirely.

Try asking: 'If you had to describe what you're most afraid of at a deep level — not a surface fear, but the thing you most want to keep from happening — what would that be?'

6A • TYPE CONFUSION OBSERVATION BLOCK

Types in question: Type 7 and Type 2. Use only if the client brought in their type confusion observation during the session.



WHAT TO DO WITH WHAT THEY BRING

- Bring the Habit of Mind data explicitly: 'Something interesting showed up in your responses — when we looked at where your attention naturally goes, it leaned more toward attending to what others need and whether they're pleased with you than toward planning and reframing toward possibility. That's worth sitting with. Which of those feels more honest when you're in a challenging moment?'
- Use the stress and security confirmations as the structural anchors for the Seven hypothesis: 'The pattern that most clearly points toward Seven is how you described stress — the movement into criticism and perfectionism rather than control and demand, which is what we'd expect for a Two. Does that distinction feel true?'
- Hold both possibilities genuinely: 'These two types both showed up in your data in meaningful ways. I don't think this is a matter of one being right and one being wrong — I think both patterns are real for you. The question is which one is the organizing one underneath.' Let the client do the work of locating that.
- The Object Relations answer is the cleanest discriminator: Sevens live in the Frustration triad and have a chronic sense that the world doesn't give them enough of what they need. Twos live in the Rejection triad and have a chronic sense that they are not loved for who they are, only for what they give. Ask the client which of those feels closer to their deepest fear.

IF THE OBSERVATION DIDN'T YIELD CLEAR DATA

- Type 7's core pattern is particularly hard to confirm through self-report in the counter-type because the client may not experience their behavior as pleasure-seeking or pain-avoiding — they experience it as genuinely devoted and selfless. The underlying avoidance of limitation and inner emptiness is not visible to them from the inside.
- Type 2's Habit of Mind (flattery, attending to others' needs and approval) can be invisible to Twos because it feels like natural care rather than strategic attention management. If this client is a Two, the approval-seeking dimension may be genuinely outside their awareness.
- Both types have access to genuine warmth and generosity, both can become tireless in service of others, and both can develop burnout through over-giving. The distinction lives at a motivational depth that self-report instruments struggle to reach, which is why a live conversation with a skilled practitioner is the right container for this particular question.

Try asking: 'At the end of a day when you've given a lot — inspired people, showed up for the cause — what's the feeling that's most present? Is it something like fullness, like you've been part of something alive? Or something more like relief that people needed you and you were there?'

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